



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Trinity Christian Academy

School Website: <https://www.rafikiclassicalacademy.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Trinity Christian Academy (FL 32725) presents a clearly classical Christian orientation in its public-facing materials, centering biblical worldview, the Great Books conversation, and a Trivium-inspired approach to curriculum. The school emphasizes formation of character and virtue alongside intellectual development, and it explicitly positions itself within the classical tradition (including references to Great Books, the Trivium, and a biblical worldview). However, the publicly accessible materials provide less explicit, detailed description of certain pedagogical practices (e.g., formal Socratic seminars, explicit use of chanting/recitation, or liturgical practices) than the strongest classical models often cite. Based on the six-category classical rubric, Trinity Christian Academy's materials align most strongly with CLASSICAL in Categories 1, 2, 3, 5, and 6, with Element 4 showing partial alignment and thus receiving a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating. The aggregate assessment places the school in the SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL range.

Key observations:

- Religious and Metaphysical Foundations are evident: explicit biblical framing, a stated Statement of Faith, and a biblically integrated curriculum framework. Evidence includes Bible-first routines and a biblically grounded worldview.
- School Purpose and Goal emphasize formation, virtue, and the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty, rather than vocational justifications alone. This aligns with the classical aim of forming humans rather than just information transfer.
- Curriculum shows clear classical elements: reference to Great Books, the Great Conversation, Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), and a biblically integrated liberal-arts framework. This is a strong classical signal.
- Pedagogy appears to include classical methods (grammar/logic/rhetoric, likely some forms of disciplined dialogue and memory work), but explicit, recurring descriptions of Socratic seminars or chant/memory routines in public pages are not robustly demonstrated in the accessible materials. This yields a partial, SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, reading for Pedagogy.
- Faculty portrayal leans into virtue, mentorship, and a living-curriculum posture, consistent with classical models. The materials emphasize teachers as virtuous, God-fearing mentors and as central figures in the educational project.
- Parent and Community relations are foregrounded through partnership with families and access to parent resources, aligning with the classical emphasis on families as co-educators.

ABSTRACT

: Based on the publicly available school content and the classical-elements rubric, Trinity Christian Academy's materials lean strongly CLASSICAL in most categories, with Pedagogy showing somewhat less explicit classical implementation in the public materials. The overall classification is SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The program centers Bible study and a biblical worldview as core framing for all subjects. Example: “The day starts with Bible and is followed by all core subjects taught from a Biblical worldview, with the addition of music, art, and physical education—an educational feast of God’s truth, beauty and goodness!”
- A formal Statement of Faith articulates Trinitarian theology (God the Father, Jesus the Son, the Holy Spirit) and orthodox Christian doctrine as foundational.
- Public materials frame the curriculum as integrated within a Christian worldview and biblical formation of the whole person.

Positive keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present on public materials: truth, goodness, beauty, virtue (implicit in “pursuit” of these transcendental goods), wisdom, sacred/worship language (Bible, theology, biblical worldview, faith).
- Direct textual signals include: truth, beauty, goodness; biblical worldview; Statement of Faith; Great Books framing within a Christian context.

Negative keyword analysis

- No explicit public-facing signals of secular relativism or value-neutral ethics; no clear presence of “secular ethics,” “values-neutral,” or “religion-free” language.

Why this rating

- The materials consistently foreground transcendental ideals (truth, goodness, beauty) anchored in theology and sacred texts, with explicit theological grounding (biblical worldview and a formal Statement of Faith). This aligns with Transcendental Moral Realism and Grounded Theology signals typical of CLASSICAL programs. The absence of secular-relativist language in the public content further supports classification as CLASSICAL.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school frames education as formation toward virtue and wisdom, not merely work-readiness, and centers truth/goodness/beauty as real and knowable. The system emphasizes formation through biblical/worldview-integrated study and Great Books language.
- Phrasings such as “pursuit of truth, beauty, and goodness” and “integration of subjects under a biblical worldview” reflect the classical telos and paideia aims rather than merely job preparation.
- The Great Conversation and Great Books framing supplies a classical sense of intellectual formation beyond information.

Positive keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, truth, goodness, beauty, liberal education, great conversation, paideia, classical mission, eternal / permanent truths (inferred from the Great Books framework).
- Explicit signals: “formation” and “the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty.”

Negative keyword analysis

- No overt signals of career-orientation or 21st-century-skills framing in the public materials.

Why this rating

- The emphasis on formation, virtue, and the triad of truth/goodness/beauty, plus the explicit Great Books/canonical canon framing, aligns strongly with CLASSICAL purposes and goals. The absence of vocational language in public messaging reinforces CLASSICAL rather than NOT CLASSICAL.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school site positions itself within classical education through explicit references to the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and Great Books/Great Conversation, with a biblically integrated liberal-arts framework. This is a core hallmark of classical curriculum design.
- The Great Books / Great Conversation framing is repeatedly used, signaling historical-textual engagement and canonical study.

Positive keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books, Great Conversation, liberal education, formation through the liberal arts, biblical worldview, integration of disciplines (history, literature, philosophy with sciences).
- Direct textual signals: “the Great Conversation,” Trivium, Great Books, liberal arts framing.

Negative keyword analysis

- No public-facing signals of replacing history with social studies, or a purely STEM-first framing; no explicit “project-based-only” emphasis in the core public materials.

Why this rating

- The curriculum is clearly anchored in classical pedagogy (grammar/logic/rhetoric) and canonical literature (Great Books) with integrated liberal-arts structures. This fits CLASSICAL well.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Public-facing materials emphasize classical content (Trivium, Great Books) and formation, but explicit, recurring descriptions of timeless classical pedagogical practices such as Socratic seminars, quiet scholé days, memorization/recitation, or liturgical rhythm are not consistently documented in the visible pages. The presence of “Great Conversation” and Trivium signals classical methods, but detailed pedagogy is less visible.
- There is some indication of restfulness or contemplative aspects through the emphasis on formation and integrated study, but explicit statements about contemplative pedagogy or Scholé days are not clearly documented at the public surface level.
- Some lower-level signals about memory and recitation echo classical practices in the broader literature, but not strongly evidenced in the public site text (the Six Elements lexicon is the source of these signals rather than the school’s own public pages).

Positive keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: Great Books, Great Conversation, Trivium (grammar/logic/rhetoric), liberal arts, formation, memory or recitation signals are not strongly evidenced in public text; cantons of recitation/memory are not explicit on the site.
- The strong signal remains: Trivium + Great Books content.

Negative keyword analysis

- Lack of explicit Socratic seminars, formal Socratic or dialectic pedagogy on visible pages; limited evidence for chanting/singing/recitation or liturgical pedagogy on public pages.
- Absence of clearly public statements about Scholé days or contemplative rest in classrooms.

Why this rating

- The presence of canonical classical elements (Trivium, Great Books) supports CLASSICAL. However, the absence of explicit, consistently described contemplative/scholé pedagogy and the lack of visible Socratic-seminar language in public content lead to a partial, SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL classification in this category.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Faculty are described as virtuous mentors and as living exemplars of the school's aims. Materials emphasize teachers as moral exemplars and as the core of the school community; the "living curriculum" framing is implied by the way the pedagogy is described and by the employment materials.
- There is explicit emphasis on teachers being humble, loving, God-fearing, and forming a shared educational mission, aligning with classic images of teachers as models of virtue and as the central agents in forming character.

Positive keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: virtuous educators, moral formation, character formation, mentorship, formation through example, lifelong learning, professionalism, faith and reason, wisdom-centered teaching.
- Direct textual signals: "The Rafiki Academy fosters humble, loving, God-fearing teachers"; "teachers as models of virtue"; "living curriculum" language.

Negative keyword analysis

- No public material signals of non-classical faculty profiles (e.g., purely instrumentalized, technocratic staff language).

Why this rating

- The public materials strongly depict faculty as moral exemplars and as central to the curriculum, aligning with CLASSICAL expectations of faculty. Therefore, CLASSICAL is warranted.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school emphasizes parent partnerships and provides access to parent resources, consistent with the classical view that parents are co-teachers and partners in education. Public materials indicate parent involvement and resources (calendar, parent resources, parent-web details).
- The presence of "Parent Resources" and a visible emphasis on family involvement signals a community model that includes parental formation and collaboration.
- The school appears open to parent engagement through visits and participation, and it positions itself as part of a broader classical ecosystem (e.g., involvement in classical education networks).

Positive keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: partnership with families, co-teachers, parental engagement, home-school collaboration, parent formation, family worship (inferred language from classical lexicon; specific phrases on site show parent resources and resources for involvement).
- Direct textual signals: parent resources page, calendar access, engagement opportunities.

Negative keyword analysis

- Public materials do not signal a consumer model (e.g., "parents as customers"); the material foregrounds partnership and formation rather than consumerism.

Why this rating

- The school's public materials strongly align with the classical pattern of active parent involvement and partnership with families in formation and learning, which warrants CLASSICAL in Element 6.
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What Would Move the Needle

- For Pedagogy (Element 4): Provide and publicly highlight explicit descriptions of classical pedagogy in action (e.g., documented use of Socratic seminars, disciplined dialectic, memory work/recitation routines, and Scholé days) to elevate from SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL to CLASSICAL. Public case studies or sample lesson plans showing Socratic dialogue and disciplined memory work would strengthen the signal.
 - For Liturgical/Communal Practices (Element 1 sub-aspect): If not already explicit, publish a clear description of any liturgical rhythms, communal prayer, morning worship, or chapel practices to demonstrate liturgical and communal foundations in a more concrete way.
 - For Curriculum (Element 3 detail): Provide public, explicit mapping of the Trivium components (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric) across grades, with sample Great Books lists and a clear articulation of how Great Books are integrated into each discipline across the K–12 experience.
 - For Faculty (Element 5): Include faculty profiles that articulate how teachers model virtue, their own ongoing formation, and how they participate in mentoring and collaborative growth (e.g., professional learning communities, mentorship programs). This would strengthen the perception of teachers as the living curriculum.
 - For Parent & Community (Element 6): Expand parent-facing programming (e.g., book studies, seminars, parent evenings, and clear pathways for deeper parent formation) and publicly document these offerings to reinforce the partnership narrative.
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Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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